County Council Meeting
Beaufort County, SC

Council Chambers, Administration Building
Beaufort County Government Robert Smalls Complex
100 Ribaut Road, Beaufort

Monday, March 9, 2026
6:00 PM

MINUTES

Watch the video stream available on the County's website to hear the Council's discussion of a specific topic or the complete meeting https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/377491

1. Call to Order

Chair Howard called the meeting to order at 6:12 PM

Present
Chair Alice Howard
Vice-Chair Anna Maria Tabernik
Council Member David Bartholomew
Council Member Paula Brown
Council Member Logan Cunningham
Council Member Gerald Dawson
Council Member York Glover - Virtual from 6:55 PM
Council Member Mark Lawson
Council Member Lawrence McElynn
Council Member Joseph Passiment
Council Member Thomas Reitz

2. Pledge of Allegiance and Invocation

Council Member Dawson led the Pledge of Allegiance and gave the invocation.

3. Statement of Compliance with FOIA

Chair Howard stated that public notification of this meeting had been published, posted, and distributed in compliance with SC FOIA.

4. Approval of Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve the agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

5. Approval of Minutes

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Glover to approve the minutes from Caucus and Council on February 23, 2026.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

6. Presentation

a. Presentation of the Time Capsule commemorating Beaufort's bicentennial celebration of the Marquis de Lafayette's historic visit to Beaufort in March 1825. - *Lise Sundrla*

Lise Sundrla presented Council with a time capsule commemorating Beaufort's bicentennial celebration of the Marquis de Lafayette's historic visit to Beaufort in March 1825.

7. Administrator's Report

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/377491

8. Public Comment Period

Public comments were made.

9. Liaison and Committee Reports

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full report.
https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/377491

10. Approval of Consent Agenda

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Lawson to approve the consent agenda.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

CONSENT AGENDA

a. Items Originating from the Public Facilities and Safety Committee

1. Approval of a Contract to Gulf Stream Construction Co. for the Rivers End Drainage Improvements Project ($1,419,054.63).

2. Approval of Contract to Low Country Commercial Services for Janitorial Services at Hilton Head Island Airport ($608,108.16).

3. Approval of a contract to W.M. Roebuck for Installation of Traffic Signal Mast Arm Poles at Bluffton Parkway at River Ridge Drive.

END OF CONSENT AGENDA

11. Discussion Item

a. Discussion of a Hate Crime Ordinance

Council directed staff to draft a Resolution and an Ordinance to come back to Community Service and Public Safety Committee.

Please watch the video stream on the county's website to view the full discussion. **https://beaufortcountysc.new.swagit.com/videos/377491**

12. Agenda Items

a. Appointment of Janet Shelley to the Beaufort Memorial Hospital Board of Trustees for a four-year term with an expiration date of February 2030.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve the appointment of Janet Shelley to the Beaufort Memorial Hospital Board of Trustees for a four-year term with an expiration date of February 2030.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

b. Appointment of Alice Howard to the Southern Carolina Alliance Board of Directors and the Southern Carolina Alliance Board of Directors Executive Committee for a three-year term with an expiration date of February 2029.

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Brown, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve the appointment of Alice Howard to the Southern Carolina Alliance Board of Directors and the Southern Carolina Alliance Board of Directors Executive Committee for a three-year term with an expiration date of February 2029.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

c. Approval of Funding to allow for Subsidies of Impact Fees for Qualified Affordable Housing pursuant to Ordinance 2015/28 and Chapter 82 Section 33 of the Beaufort County General Code of Ordinances.

The vote at County Council on January 12, 2026 - 7:4
Council referred this item back to the Natural Resource Committee during the liaison and committee report at the County Council meeting on January 12, 2026
The vote at Natural Resources Committee on February 3, 2026 - 5:2

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Dawson, seconded by Council Member McElynn to approve funding to allow for Subsidies of Impact Fees for Qualified Affordable Housing pursuant to Ordinance 2015/28 and Chapter 82 Section 33 of the Beaufort County General Code of Ordinances.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Cunningham, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 8:3.

13. Ordinances for Third Reading

a. 2026/03: An Ordinance authorizing the acceptance of a drainage easement located on Leo Green Rd.

The vote at Public Facilities and Safety Committee on January 20, 2026 - 10:0
The vote at First Reading on February 9, 2026 - 10:0
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on February 23, 2026 - 11:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Dawson to approve third reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/03.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Glover, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 11:0.

b. 2026/05: An Ordinance authorizing the abandonment of a drainage easement recorded in Deed Book 3695 at Pages 3345-3347 & Deed Book 3695 at Pages 3348-3350 located off Gumwood Drive in northern Lady's Island.

The vote at Public Facilities and Safety Committee on January 20, 2026 - 9:0
The vote at First Reading on February 9, 2026 - 10:0
The vote at Second Reading and Public Hearing on February 23, 2026 - 11:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Passiment, seconded by Council Member Bartholomew to approve third reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/05.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

*Council Member Glover dropped off

14. Ordinances for Second Reading

a. 2026/06: An Ordinance adding a new Section 54-8 to the Beaufort County Code of Ordinances so as to prohibit and make unlawful the discharge of firearms in certain unincorporated areas of the county, to provide the penalty pertaining to such violations, and to provide certain expectations and limitations thereto. **PUBLIC HEARING**

The vote at Community Services and Public Safety Committee on February 3, 2026 - 6:2
The vote at First Reading on February 23, 2026 - 7:4

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Council Member Reitz to postpone the second reading of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/06 to the March 23, 2026, Council Meeting.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

Public comments were taken.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 10:0.

*Council Member Glover dropped off

b. 2026/07: An ordinance amending the Zoning map for 5 acres (R300 016 000 0063 0000, R300 016 000 0064 0000, R300 016 000 0065 0000) from T3HN to T4VC. **PUBLIC HEARING**

The vote at Natural Resources Committee on February 3, 2026 - 6:0:1
The vote at First Reading on February 23, 2026 - 8:2:1
At their November 3, 2025 meeting, the Planning Commission voted 8-0 recommending approval of the rezoning.

Motion: It was moved by Chair Howard, seconded by Council Member Brown to approve second reading and public hearing of Beaufort County Ordinance 2026/07.

Vice-Chair Tabernik opened the floor for public comment.

No one came forward.

Vice-Chair Tabernik closed the floor for public comment.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Brown, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, and Council Member Passiment.

Voting Nay: Council Member Cunningham and Council Member Reitz.

Recused: Council Member Glover. The motion passed 8:2:1.

15. Resolutions

a. 2026/06: A Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to enter a Memorandum of Agreement with Marine Corps Recruit Depot Parris Island for Mutual Emergency Medical Services Response.

The vote at Community Services and Public Safety Committee on March 2, 2026 - 7:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/06.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

*Council Member Glover dropped off, and Council Member Brown had left the room.

b. 2026/07: A Resolution Recognizing April As Fair Housing Month

The vote at Community Services and Public Safety Committee on March 2, 2026 - 7:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/07.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

*Council Member Glover dropped off, and Council Member Brown had left the room.

c. 2026/08: A Resolution authorizing the County Administrator to enter into a Memorandum of Understanding with the Port Royal Sound Foundation for collaboration on natural resource monitoring and outreach, including work on the National Fish and Wildlife Foundation Grant

awarded to the County.

The vote at Community Services and Public Safety Committee on March 2, 2026 - 7:0

Motion: It was moved by Council Member Bartholomew, seconded by Vice-Chair Tabernik to approve Beaufort County Resolution 2026/08.

The Vote - Voting Yea: Chair Howard, Vice-Chair Tabernik, Council Member Bartholomew, Council Member Cunningham, Council Member Dawson, Council Member Lawson, Council Member McElynn, Council Member Passiment, and Council Member Reitz. The motion passed 9:0.

*Council Member Glover dropped off, and Council Member Brown had left the room.

16. Adjournment

COUNTY COUNCIL OF BEAUFORT COUNTY



BY: _____
Alice G. Howard, Chairman

ATTEST:



_____
Sarah W. Brock, Clerk to Council
Ratified: March 23, 2026